ST. PHILOMENA'S COLLEGE (Autonomous), MYSORE
Autonomous College affiliated with the University of Mysore.
Reaccredited by NAAC with B++Grade
Post Box No. 30, Bannimantap, Mysore-570 015.
Email: stphilos1946@gmail.com

MINUTES OF THE FINANCE COMMITTEE MEETING

Date: 09.09.2025 Venue: UG Conference Hall Time: 10:30 AM

Dr. Ravi J.D. Saldanha, the Principal, welcomed the members and provided a brief overview of the administrative structure, academic profile, and the current programmes offered by the institution. He also introduced the newly inducted members of the Finance Committee – Mr. Britto Dominic Rayan, Dean of Science, senior Teacher and Dr. Reena Francis, Controller of Examinations. The Principal further informed the committee that these new members were inducted to the Finance Committee as Dr. Alphonsus D'Souza, Senior Teacher and Mr. Nagaraj Urs M, Vice Principal (Academics) were superannuated. He further thanked the superannuated members for their services.

The following members were present:

Sl. No.	Name of the Member	Designation
1.	Dr. Ravi J D Saldanha	Principal & Chairperson
2.	Rev. Dr. Lourdu Prasad Joseph	Rector
3.	Rev. Fr. Naveen Kumar	Treasurer – MDES
4.	Smt. Rekha K.S.	Finance Officer- University of Mysore

5.	Mr. Ronald Prakash Cutinha	Vice Principal – Administration
6.	Mr. Thomas Gunaseelan	IQAC Coordinator
7.	Dr. Reena Francis	Controller of Examinations
8.	Dr. Britto Dominic Rayan	Senior Teacher
9.	Dr. Noor Mubasheer C A	PG Coordinator
10.	Ms. Venitha Lobo	Office Superintendent
11.	Mr. Naveena S	Accountant

Members Absent: Nil

The following agenda was taken up for discussion and approval:

Agenda 1: The minutes of the previous meeting held on 25th October 2024

The Principal sought the approval of the minutes of the previous meeting which was circulated among the members. It was proposed by Smt. Rekha K.S. – Finance Officer, University of Mysore, and seconded by Mr. Thomas Gunaseelan, IQAC Coordinator.

Decision: Approved

Agenda 2: The Audited Receipts & Payments Statement for Govt. Aided A/C's for the financial year 2024-25

Audited Accounts copies of aided accounts were distributed to all the members for deliberation and approval.

Principal explained about the various aided and unaided courses offered by the college. Mr. Ronald Prakash Cutinha elaborated on the history of various aided programmes and also the programmes introduced after

autonomy, noting that the programmes were aligned with student aspirations. He also stated that admissions for the current academic year 2025–26 stood at 826, while many private colleges in the region had recorded very low admissions.

Smt. Rekha K S enquired about fee payments by SC/ST students, to which Dr. Noor clarified that these students first pay the fees and later receive reimbursement through scholarships.

Smt. Rekha K S also raised queries about the preparation of the fee structure, and Ms. Venitha Lobo explained that it is prepared based on government circulars, with a 5% increase for 2025–26. After due deliberation, Smt. Rekha approved the accounts for the year 2024–25 and the same was accepted

Decision: Approved

Agenda 3: The Audited Receipts & Payments Statement for Self Financing (Unaided) A/C's for the financial year 2024-25

Mr. Naveena S, Accountant, explained about the various bank accounts maintained by the college and the collections under different heads. Smt. Rekha enquired about the fee collection of various programmes from UG, PG, MBA and MCA for which Rev. Dr. Lourdu Prasad Joseph, Rector explained and clarified about the fee collection.

Rev. Fr. Naveen Kumar, Treasurer – MDES, suggested that fees collected for sports and cultural activities be retained by the College for conducting programmes rather than remitting them to the University. In response, Smt. Rekha stated that all prescribed fees must be paid to the University as per regulations.

Mr. Ronald Prakash Cutinha observed that the College has financial obligations not only towards the University but also to the AICTE, since the BBA and BCA programmes now come under its purview. These additional commitments have reduced the funds available for the College's internal utilization. He further noted that the institution has not been able to revise its fee structure since the COVID period, while autonomous Colleges are expected to make a one-time payment to the University, in reality, the University continues to collect fees on par with affiliated colleges. In response, Smt. Rekha remarked that such challenges stem largely from the Government's inadequate focus on higher education and the absence of sufficient financial support or policy relaxations.

Dr. Noor Mubasheer, PG Coordinator, pointed out that research students in private colleges face significant challenges, as they are required to pay an additional rupees 2 to 3 lakhs compared to University students, whose fee structure is considerably lower. He expressed concern that this disparity adversely affects the growth of research. In response, Smt. Rekha clarified that the University's regulations in this regard are explicit and that payments must be made strictly as prescribed.

Mr. Ronald Prakash Cutinha emphasized that, unlike many private institutions, St. Philomena's College strives to provide quality education at nominal costs and therefore requires certain relaxations from the University. In response, Smt. Rekha noted that the University itself faces challenges in maintaining quality and that higher education remains a neglected sector. She added that policy changes may be possible if private institutions collectively raise their concerns.

Dr. Reena Francis, Controller of Examinations, enquired whether it was necessary to pay Convocation Fees to the University since degree certificates are no longer issued physically and are now made available to students through Digi Locker. In response, Smt. Rekha clarified that the payment of Convocation Fees remains mandatory for the College as per University regulations.

Dr. Ravi J D Saldanha, the Principal explained that the College regularly incurs expenses towards outreach programmes, seminars, conferences, faculty development programmes, and training sessions for non-teaching staff each semester. He also briefed the members on the NAAC process and the institution's readiness for assessment. Later, Mr. Ronald Prakash Cutinha elaborated on the new NAAC guidelines under the Binary and Maturity models.

Smt. Rekha finally concluded that the obligatory fees towards the University needs to paid by all the affiliated colleges. After due deliberation, Smt. Rekha approved the unaided accounts for the year 2024–25 and the same was accepted.

Decision: Approved

Agenda 4: The Audited Receipts and Payments Statement for UGC A/C's for the financial year 2024-25

Mr. Ronald Prakash Cutinha informed the members that, the unused balance amount in the College's UGC accounts which was meant for Community College program utilization needed to be refunded with interest

to the UGC in line with revised rules and regulations. He presented the correspondence regarding the refund and its acknowledgment from UGC. The explanation was accepted by Smt. Rekha.

Decision: Approved

Agenda 5: The Students Fee Structure for Government Aided and Self Financing (Unaided) UG, PG & MBA/MCA Courses for the financial year 2025-26

The fee structures of both aided and unaided courses were presented, and the Rector explained that the fees had been reduced for the academic year 2025–26. Smt. Rekha suggested that the percentage of reduction be displayed for clarity. The Rector clarified that a uniform percentage could not be calculated since the reduction varied across courses. The explanation was accepted by Smt. Rekha.

Decision: Approved

Agenda 6: Budget allocation under different heads for the year 2025-26 for Govt. Aided & Self- Financing (Unaided) UG, PG & MBA/MCA Courses

Smt. Rekha sought clarification on whether the balance of funds in one account was being utilized for other accounts. The Rector assured that no reallocation of funds takes place between accounts. Both the aided and unaided fee statements were presented for scrutiny.

The Principal then briefed the committee on proposed future projects, including the construction of the MBA and MCA block, and the funds earmarked for the same. In response, Smt. Rekha observed that the entire allocation should not be made in the current year, as the work may extend into the following year.

The Rector presented the cost estimates of the projects, after which Smt. Rekha recommended that allocations be made phase-wise at the time of execution, with specific remarks indicating project details

Decision: Approved with Finance Officer's recommendation to allocate the funds in a Phased manner.

Agenda 7: Any other matter with the permission of the Chairman

Mr. Britto Dominic Rayan requested an enhancement of paper valuation and examination invigilation fees, noting that revisions had not been made for a long time. In response, Smt. Rekha observed that while the University had increased remuneration despite audit objections, private autonomous colleges could also seek permission for such enhancements, provided they were willing to bear the additional financial burden with the approval of their Governing Body.

Rev. Fr. Naveen Kumar suggested that an increase in examination fees for students could support the enhancement of payments for examination-related work.

Decision: Pending with the approval from the Governing Body

Mr. Ronald Prakash Cutinha, Vice Principal (Administration), proposed a formal vote of thanks. He expressed sincere gratitude to the Chairperson and all the members of the Finance Committee for their gracious presence, active participation, and valuable contributions, which enriched the deliberations and added significance to the meeting. The meeting was adjourned thereafter.

Minutes Recorded by: Mrs. Soni Selvi Vinayagam, Office Superintendent, AICTE programmes, SPC, Mysore.

Date: 11th September, 2025. **Principal/Chairman**